



RKDF UNIVERSITY, BHOPAL
Bachelor of Arts (B.A.)
Second Semester

Course	Category	Subject	Subject Code
B.A.	Major	British Literature: 18th Century (Theory)	BA-EN 201
Total Credit: 6		Max.Marks:100 (Internal:40+External:60)	

SYLLABUS

Units	Topic	Duration (In Hours)	Marks
I	• Drama William Congreve: The Way of the World[t] 131 Keywords: Restoration Comedy, Antisentimental drama, Romance, Wit, Greed, Jealousy	15	25
II	Porse Joseph Addison: The Spectator's Account of Himself, Sir Roger at Home, Sir Roger at Church, The Vision of Mirza ("" (4, Keywords: Neo-classicism, Prose, Satire, Individual vs. Society	18	25

III	Poetry Samuel Johnson: 'London' ¹³¹ Thomas Gray: 'Elegy Written in a Country Churchyard' [31 Keywords: Urban vs. Rustic life, Poverty and Violence, Corruption of Education, Elegy, Graveyard School of Poetry, Death, Remembrance, Anonymity vs. Fame	12	25
IV	Fiction Laurence Sterne: The Life and Opinions of Tristram Shandy, Gentleman (1) Keywords: Novel, Fictional autobiography, Psychological fiction, Family drama, Wisdom and Foolishness, Time	15	25

Unit I

Introduction

The Way of the World by William Congreve Plot Summary

The way of the world summary explores the play in brief. This play is a comedy of manners. Moreover, it gives a satirical take on the approach, mannerism, and shortcomings of the privileged classes. Deception, greed and love are common throughout the way of the world summary. It is about two lovers, Mirabell and Millamant, finding ways to marry each other and not losing the inheritance. It is full of characters who are connected to each other in some way or the other. Moreover, it also exposes some of the dark secrets of the characters. Mirabell and Millamant wish to marry each other but are aware Millamant's aunt, Lady Wishfort, won't allow

it. They need her approval to inherit the fortune which lies in her hands. Thus, it gives an interesting take on the lengths the couple goes to for achieving the same through whatever means.

The Way of the World is a restoration comedy written by William Congreve. Through the way of the world summary, we will get a better understanding of the play. It begins with Mirabell and Fainall playing cards. A man enters to inform Mirabell that his servant, Whitwell, and Lady Wishfort's servant, Foible got married. Thus, Mirabell confesses to Fainall about his love for Millamant. Further, Mirabell learns that on Lady Wishfort's marriage, Millamant will lose the fortune she is to inherit from her aunt. Thus, they can get the money only if Lady Wishfort agrees to their marriage. In the second act of the way of the world summary, Mrs Fainall and Mrs Marwood talk about their abhorrence for men. Suddenly, Fainall arrives to accuse Mrs Marwood of being in love with Mirabell.

In the interim, Mrs Fainall expresses her hatred for her husband to Mirabell. Thus, they begin plotting to trick Lady Wishfort into agreeing to the marriage. Next, we see Foible, encouraging Lady Wishfort to marry Sir Rowland (Whitwell in disguise). Thus, the main plan is to trap her in marriage which won't go ahead as it will be bigamy and also a social disgrace because of the class differences. Thus, Mirabell will lend her a helping hand to sort it out if she agrees to the marriage. As Mrs Fainall discusses this plan with Foible, Mrs Marwood overhears the conversation. She reveals the plan to Fainall who has decided to take Mrs Fainall's money and elope with Mrs Marwood.

Further, in the way of the world summary, Mirabell proposes to Millamant and she accepts happily. As Mirabell leaves, Lady Wishfort enters and tells Millamant, she wants her to marry her nephew, Sir Wilfull. After that, Lady Wishfort receives a letter that reveals the Sir Rowland

plot. He then accuses Mirabell of harming their wedding. Thus, Whitewell is arrested by Fainall. Lady Wishfort is grateful to Mrs Marwood for revealing the plot. Then, we see Fainall using the information of Mrs Fainall's former affair with Mirabell plus Millimant's contract of blackmailing Lady Wishfort. He tells her to not remarry and transfer her fortune to him. However, Mirabell comes to the rescue to save her fortune and honour. Thus, all the blackmailing stops and everything is gets back in place. Finally, Millimant gets her inheritance and blessings to marry Mirabell.

Conclusion of The Way of the World Summary

The Way of the World summary revolves around marriage, infidelity as well as inheritance. It explores the human mind and willingness to get what they want through whatever means.

Unit II

Joseph Addison:

The Spectator's Account of Himself, Sir Roger at Home, Sir Roger at Church

Having often received an invitation from my friend Sir Roger de Coverley to pass away a month with him in the country, I last week accompanied him thither, and am settled with him for some time at his country-house, where I intend to form several of my ensuing speculations. Sir Roger, who is very well acquainted with my humour, lets me rise and go to bed when I please; dine at his own table, or in my chamber, as I think fit; sit still, and say nothing, without bidding me be merry. When the gentlemen of the country come to see him,

he only shows me at a distance. As I have been walking in his fields, I have observed them stealing a sight of me over an hedge, and have heard the knight desiring them not to let me see them, for that I hated to be stared at.

I am the more at ease in Sir Roger's family, because it consists of sober and staid persons; for as the knight is the best master in the world, he seldom changes his servants and as he is beloved by all about him, his servants never care for leaving him: by this means his domestics are all in years, and grown old with their master. You would take his *valet de chambre* for his brother; his butler is grey-headed; his groom is one of the gravest men that I have ever seen; and his coachman has the looks of a privy-councillor. You see the goodness of the master even in the old house-dog; and in a gray pad, that is kept in the stable with great care and tenderness out of regard to his past services, though he has been useless for several years.

I could not but observe with a great deal of pleasure, the joy that appeared in the countenances of these ancient domestics upon my friend's arrival at his country-seat. Some of them could not refrain from tears at the sight of their old master; every one of them pressed forward to do something for him, and seemed discouraged if they were not employed. At the same time the good old knight, with a mixture of the father and the master of the family, tempered the inquiries after his own affairs with several kind questions relating to themselves. This humanity and good nature engages everybody to him, so that when he is pleasant upon any of them, all his family are in good humour, and none so much as the person whom he diverts himself with: on the contrary, if he coughs, or betrays any infirmity of old age, it is easy for a stander-by to observe a secret concern in the looks of all his servants.

My worthy friend has put me under the particular care of his butler, who is a very prudent man, and, as well as the rest of his fellow-servants, wonderfully desirous of pleasing me,

because they have often heard their master talk of me as of his particular friend.

My chief companion, when Sir Roger is diverting himself in the woods or the fields, is a very venerable man, who is ever with Sir Roger, and has lived at his house in the nature of a chaplain above thirty years. This gentleman is a person of good sense, and some learning, of a very regular life, and obliging conversation: he heartily loves Sir Roger, and knows that he is very much in the old knight's esteem; so that he lives in the family rather as a relation than a dependant.

I have observed in several of my papers, that my friend Sir Roger, amidst all his good qualities, is something of an humourist; and that his virtues, as well as imperfections, are, as it were, tinged by a certain extravagance, which make them particularly his, and distinguishes them from those of other men. This cast of mind, as it is generally very innocent in itself, so it renders his conversation highly agreeable, and more delightful than the same degree of sense and virtue would appear in their common and ordinary colours. As I was walking with him last night, he asked me how I liked the good man whom I have just now mentioned: and, without staying for my answer, told me, that he was afraid of being insulted with Latin and Greek at his own table ; for which reason, he desired a particular friend of his at the University, to find him out a clergyman rather of plain sense than much learning, of a good aspect, a clear voice, a sociable temper, and, if possible, a man that understood a little of backgammon.

"My friend (*says Sir Roger*) found me out this gentleman, who, besides the endowments required of him, is, they tell me, a good scholar, though he does not show it. I have given him the parsonage of the parish; and because I know his value, have settled upon him a good annuity for life. If he outlives me, he shall find that he was higher in my esteem than perhaps he thinks he is. He has now been with me thirty years; and, though he does not know I have taken notice of it, has never in all that time asked anything of me for himself, though he is

every day soliciting me for something in behalf of one or other of my tenants, his parishioners. There has not been a law-suit in the parish since he has lived among them: if any dispute arises, they apply themselves to him for the decision; if they do not acquiesce in his judgment, which I think never happened above once, or twice at most, they appeal to me. At his first settling with me, I made him a present of all the good sermons which have been printed in English, and only begged of him that every Sunday he would pronounce one of them in the pulpit. Accordingly, he has digested them into such a series, that they follow one another naturally, and make a continued system of practical divinity."

As Sir Roger was going on in his story, the gentleman we were talking of came up to us; and upon the knight's asking him who preached tomorrow, (for it was Saturday night,) told us, the Bishop of St. Asaph in the morning, and Dr. South in the afternoon. He then showed us his list of preachers for the whole year, where I saw with a great deal of pleasure, Archbishop Tillotson, Bishop Saunderson, Doctor Barrow, Doctor Calamy, with several living authors who have published discourses of practical divinity. I no sooner saw this venerable man in the pulpit, but I very much approved of my friend's insisting upon the qualifications of a good aspect and a clear voice; for I was so charmed with the gracefulness of his figure and delivery, as well as the discourses he pronounced, that I think I never passed any time more to my satisfaction. A sermon repeated after this manner, is like the composition of a poet in the mouth of a graceful actor.

I could heartily wish that more of our country clergy would follow this example; and, instead of wasting their spirits in laborious compositions of their own, would endeavour after a handsome elocution, and all those other talents that are proper to enforce what has been penned by greater masters. This would not only be more easy to themselves, but more edifying to the people.

Sir Roger at Home,

Introduction: In the Coverley Essays, Sir Roger has been characterized vividly by Joseph Addison and Richard Steele. Sir Roger is presented in these essays as kind, generous, lovable, and sometimes as a peculiar person. But in the hand of Joseph Addison, Sir Roger's character is conveyed ironically. For that reason he sometimes seems odd. Although he is gentle and mild and lovable to people, he has some eccentricities and oddities. Joseph Addison's essay "Sir Roger at Church" is about a unique individual named Sir Roger. Addison begins the essay by saying that the observance of Sunday as a holy day keeps mankind civilized and polished. On Sundays people are at their very best. They appear clean and talk to other people on boring topics. Just like a merchant discusses exchange rates, the Parish people discuss the affairs of the parish. Sir Roger has spent a lot of money on the church and continues to do so. Most of the parishioners are his tenants and he has a degree of control over them. Sir Roger employs a singer to help them sing their hymns in church properly. This has dramatically improved the services at the church. However Roger has many peculiarities. He often falls asleep during the service, but would not allow anyone else to sleep while the service is going on. Another habit of his is to continue singing even when everyone else has stopped. He also continues saying Amen multiple times if he is satisfied with his piety. While everybody else kneels in the church, he stands to count the number of people to find out who is absent. The chaplain of the church has no issues with Sir Roger as he provides money for the improvement of the church. Yet in the nearby village, things are not that smooth. The parson (priest) and the squire (similar to a landlord like Sir Roger) have many differences of opinion and hence the squire does not come to church. He also prevents his tenants from going to church or contributing any money to it. Neither the parson, nor the squire is ready to settle their issues. Addison says that these kinds of feuds affect the ordinary people in parishes in the countryside. Humanity: Sir Roger is a man of humanity and has a large heart. Moreover, he is mild. He loves not only the servants of his house but also the people who live around

him. In the essay "Sir Roger at Church" we see that he is asking about the condition of the people who are absent in the church. It suggests that he is very kind-hearted and generous for whom he is very aware of others. Lover of religion: He is a true lover of religion. He is a regular churchgoer and encourages others to come to the church. His mind is set for religious purposes and he does a lot of jobs for religion. In the essay "Sir Roger at Church", we see that he has decorated and beautified the church on his own accord and at his own expense so that the country people would be encouraged to come to the church enthusiastically. In this essay he says, "My friend sir Roger, being a good churchman, has beautified the inside of his church with several texts of his own choosing. He has likewise given a handsome pulpit-cloth, and railed in the communion-table at his own expense." Sir Roger has authoritative power both in-home and church. In the church, one can see that he keeps his authoritative power. In the essay "Sir Roger at Church", the author says, "As Sir Roger is landlord to the whole congregation, he keeps them in good order, and will suffer no body to sleep in it." Even if he sees anybody is nodding, whether it is in the middle of the congregation or not, he calls to that person or sends his servants to him to make him alert. Moreover, he appoints the clergymen for the church on his own accord and suggests them to follow the instructions of different professors for sermons. In summing up, it can be said that despite being a man of great honor, Sir Roger is regarded as a humourist and sometimes eccentric because of having some oddities or peculiarities in him. However, the ultimate aim of Addison was not to show his humorous expressions to make up laugh only, rather make up correct for our follies and absurdities. But the main intention of Mr. Spectator was to correct the society, to reform every corner of life by presenting the character, Sir Roger.

Addison's Prose Style: - Addison is one of the greatest prose stylists in English literary history. He was the pioneer of a style that was very simple, lucid, natural, moderate, free

from extravagant expression, and called 'middle style'. The most striking feature of Addison's style is clearness and lucidity of expression. There is no complexity or obscurity or difficulty in his expression. Even, his long sentences are not difficult to understand. We can guess the meaning of his long sentences very clearly at the very first reading. Addison has also used short sentences when situation demands. For example, 'As soon as the sermon is finished, nobody presumes to stir till Sir Roger is gone out of the Church.' Humor is one of the most notable qualities of Addison's style. His humor is mainly ironical and satirical and sometimes funny. It is not harsh or bitter but gentle and mild with a view of correcting the society. Addison's style is not highly figurative. Fanciful similes and metaphors are not found in his writings. Rather, when he thinks that his use of figurative language would be more useful and effective, only then he uses them. Addison uses many allusions, anecdotes, references.

Unit III

Samuel Johnson: London

'London' was written by Dr. Samuel Johnson in 1738 in imitation of the Third Satire of Juvenal. In Juvenal, Umbricius leaves Rome because of corruption and hypocrisy. In this poem by Johnson, Thales is leaving London because of the vices and follies of the people who are living there. This poem consists of 263 lines. The first 34 lines of the poem are spoken by the narrator or Johnson. For the rest, Thales is the sole speaker.

*Tho' Grief and Fondness in my Breast rebel,
When injur'd Thales bids the Town farewell,
Yet still my calmer Thoughts his Choice commend,
I praise the Hermit, but regret the Friend,*

*Resolved at length, from Vice and London far,
To breathe in distant Fields a purer Air,
And, fix'd on Cambria's solitary shore,
Give to St. David one true Briton more.
For who would leave, unbrib'd, Hibernia's Land,
Or change the Rocks of Scotland for the Strand?
There none are swept by sudden Fate away,
But all whom Hunger spares, with Age decay:
Here Malice, Rapine, Accident, conspire,
And now a Rabble Rages, now a Fire;
Their Ambush here relentless Ruffians lay,
And here the fell Attorney prowls for Prey;
Here falling Houses thunder on your Head,
And here a female Atheist talks you dead.
While Thales waits the Wherry that contains
Of dissipated Wealth the small Remains,
On Thames's Banks, in silent Thought we stood,
Where Greenwich smiles upon the silver Flood:
Struck with the Seat that gave Eliza Birth,
We kneel, and kiss the consecrated Earth;
In pleasing Dreams the blissful Age renew,
And call Britannia's Glories back to view;
Behold her Cross triumphant on the Main,
The Guard of Commerce, and the Dread of Spain,
Ere Masquerades debauch'd, Excise oppress'd,
Or English Honour grew a standing Jest.*

In the poem 'London,' the narrator's friend, Thales, describes why he does not want to live in London and wants to leave the city. He states that he is leaving this place because he can not stand to live with hypocrites. Thales also satirizes the government in power at that time. He satirizes them by saying that they are bribing some common people to follow their rules so that others can also follow the same. He also praises King Henry V and Queen Elizabeth and describes the development they made during their reign in the city of London. There are a lot of things Thales wants to say to his friend, but, at this moment, a boat arrives. He boards on the boat wishing his friend happiness and success.

Themes

Johnson's poem taps on the themes of corruption, hypocrisy, and rustic life. According to Thales, there is a lot of corruption in London. The ruffians are roaming on the streets and can rob anyone at any time. There are a lot of hypocrites in the city. Rustic life is much better than the urban life of London as it is much purer. Thales would rather go to the countryside rather than staying in the city.

Thomas Gray: 'Elegy Written in a Country Churchyard

"Elegy Written in a Country Churchyard" is the British writer Thomas Gray's most famous poem, first published in 1751. The poem's speaker calmly mulls over death while standing in a rural graveyard in the evening. Taking stock of the graves, he reflects that death comes for everyone in the end, and notes that the elaborate tombs of the rich won't bring their occupants back from the dead. He also commemorates the common folk buried in the churchyard by imaging the lives they might have lived had they been born into better circumstances, and considers the benefits of anonymity. The poem ends with his own imagined epitaph.

"Elegy Written in a Country Churchyard" Summary

The curfew tolls the knell of parting day,
The lowing herd wind slowly o'er the lea,
The plowman homeward plods his weary way,
And leaves the world to darkness and to me.

Now fades the glimm'ring landscape on the sight,
And all the air a solemn stillness holds,
Save where the beetle wheels his droning flight,
And drowsy tinklings lull the distant folds;

Save that from yonder ivy-mantled tow'r
The moping owl does to the moon complain

Of such, as wand'ring near her secret bow'r,
Molest her ancient solitary reign.

Critical Analysis of Elegy Written in a Country Churchyard by Thomas

Gray has been one of the most prominent poets of English Literature and his fame lies upon the poem *Elegy Written in a Country Churchyard* although he has written many other works. The poem is one of the beautiful and finest elegies written in English literature. The poem took around seven years to complete and remains immortal to date. The major idea behind writing this piece is to make people realize that death cannot be avoided. The speaker is sitting on a graveyard and as the sun sets, he ponders over the fact that death is universal. He says that wealth, power or fame cannot save people from death and there are times when most people die with unfinished ambitions in their hearts. As we reach towards the core of the poem we realize that death will come to all whether they are rich, poor and even the narrator will die one day. Elegy is a poem written to lament one's death and this theme is aptly used in the poem. The elegy is meant for everyone who has been buried in Country Churchyard, a graveyard that is attached to a rural church. It is also for those who will be buried in the same graveyard in the future, including the narrator. The poem is not only for those who are not in this world anymore but also reminds all mortal beings of the fact that death is unavoidable at any cost. The poem also touches the sentiments of the narrator and there is a darkness that surrounds the churchyard with an inescapable and hovering mortality. The bells of the church remind the speaker of the parting day and leave him alone as the night falls. The speaker can see death everywhere as the light starts fading in the graveyard as if death has covered the world completely. The speaker thinks about all the graves around him and is struck by the realization that people die irrespective of the fact that they are rich or poor. The graves in the churchyard look very dirty but the speaker says that even if a rich person has a beautiful grave he will never return to this world alive. The speaker also talks

about the proper burials of powerful and rich people to convey that death is a universal phenomenon. Some people will have trophies on their tombs or busts and urns on their graves which makes people understand their achievements but these things cannot call the fading breath back into a dead man's body. Death does not listen to any praises in favour of the person who is no more and neither any amount of glory and fame can defeat death. The speaker says that whenever a person dies, he dies for good. The narrator also discusses his death and imagines that he will be buried under an old tree. The poem ends with an imaginary epitaph from the narrator. The poem starts with a gloomy note and ends with the narrator's death which makes the poem completely soaked in death which is inescapable, universal and ultimate. Though the speaker says that death cannot be escaped and it comes to everyone, he also speaks about the value of remembering, honouring or just imagining the life of those who are no more. The poem suggests that if we do so it can become a meaningful act of remembering those whom history and the world have forgotten long back. The poem also tries to convey that these acts of remembering someone can help us face our mortality. Commemorating the dead makes it easy for us to live and enjoy the present. The people who have been buried in the churchyard do not have any proper memorials and the narrator says that their graves are heaps of dirt and dust without any proper decorations which are found on the tombs of rich people. The graves at the most have their names and years during which they were alive. All the simple graves have a grave effect on the narrator who imagines what kind of lives these people might have led when they were alive. He imagines that they would have woken up by the call of a rooster. He thinks that they would have cheerfully ploughed their lands by driving a team of oxen. He also thinks that one of them might have stood up against the tyranny of the greedy landlord of the village. While thinking about the lives of these people, he honours them with all his heart. He imagines that their lives had meaning and genuine emotions. He also says that even the small and simple traces of the dead can

have a deep effect on those who are living. These simple gravestones can make people think of their death. The narrator says that simple rural people engrave Biblical verses and poetries on their graves to teach a mortal rural living being the art of death. People like to crave sayings that can provide some wisdom about dying and death. Visiting someone's grave not only implies that we should remember someone's life but also face death and find a way to accept it. The poem says that the dead are remembered for two reasons. The first one is honouring and remembering those who are no longer in this world and the second is facing the fact that death is inevitable. When the narrator ponders over death, he also thinks about the common people who have died without power, fame or wealth. He realizes that many people would have become famous and great if they had grown up under the right conditions. He does not regret the fact but instead says that these people led less troubled lives as compared to the elite class. The narrator rejects fame, wealth and power and celebrates regular people who lead normal lives. The poem says that anonymity is better for one's soul. The narrator imagines the power and fame common people might have got if they were born in high-class families. The speaker expresses this idea metaphorically by saying that many flowers bloom and nobody looks at them. The same implies to common people, whose power and skills can go unrecognized at times. The narrator then imagines this potential with reference to some famous people of the past. He imagines that there might be few people in these graves who might have achieved the heights of John Milton, a famous poet of the Puritan Age. The dead, however, were illiterate and restricted to rural trade so they never got a chance to write glorious poems and they were rather unable to express their thoughts in a written form. The wasted potential imagination of the narrator is pretty sad but then he thinks about the horrible people who got power in history. He mentions Oliver Cromwell who ruled England during the mid 17th century and says that someone in this graveyard might have the same potential for injustice but never got a chance because of their anonymity. He says that

the lives of common people prevent them from becoming a monster. Their place in the world has contained their crimes to a greater degree. They are simple and unknown farmers who live from one harvest to another and do not slaughter anyone for getting the throne. The narrator says after considering everything that power, fame or wealth are not important as common people have simple wishes. Regular people want understandable and simple things like food and a roof which makes them stay away from the dirty fights of powerful people. Commoners can find happiness by keeping their minds clear. The speaker says that he can relate to this anonymity. The narrator, in the epitaph written at the end of the poem, thinks of himself as a young man who never received an education and dies without wealth and fame. Though he dies with sadness in his heart, he has found peace in anonymity. He dies without being polluted by fame or wealth. The poem says that life may not be happy but anonymity gives a golden chance to people to live and die in peace without having a cruel or over the top ambition. There are different kinds of symbols used in the poem to deepen its meaning and enhance its beauty. Darkness and night in the poem are a symbol of isolation and death. The darkness shows the inevitability of death. The darkness in the poem also shows the isolation of the poet from other people. To overcome this isolation, the poet starts imaging the lives of those who have been dead. The yew tree is also a symbol of death and is a common tree found in British graveyards. The darkness makes the poet feel that death is closing on to him. The light and fire are symbols of life in the poem. It can be concluded that the poem, on the one hand, talks about death and on the other hand it also talks about methods of accepting death by understanding the lives of those who lived and taking inspiration from them.

Unit IV

Fiction Laurence Sterne: The Life and Opinions of Tristram Shandy

The most striking formal and technical characteristics of *Tristram Shandy* are its unconventional time scheme and its self-declared digressive-progressive style. Sterne, through his fictional author-character Tristram, defiantly refuses to present events in their proper chronological order. Again and again in the course of the novel Tristram defends his authorial right to move backward and forward in time as he chooses. He also relies so heavily on digressions that plot elements recede into the background; the novel is full of long essayistic passages remarking on what has transpired or, often, on something else altogether. Tristram claims that his narrative is both digressive *and* progressive, calling our attention to the way in which his authorial project is being advanced at the very moments when he seems to have wandered farthest afield.

By fracturing the sequence of the stories he tells and interjecting them with chains of associated ideas, memories, and anecdotes, Tristram allows thematic significance to emerge out of surprising juxtapositions between seemingly unrelated events. The association of ideas is a major theme of the work, however, and not just a structural principle. Part of the novel's self-critique stems from the way the author often mocks the perverseness by which individuals associate and interpret events based on their own private mental preoccupations. The author's own ideas and interpretations are presumably just as singular, and so the novel remains above all a catalogue of the "opinions" of Tristram Shandy.

Much of the subtlety of the novel comes from the layering of authorial voice that Sterne achieves by making his protagonist the author of his own life story, and then presenting that story as the novel itself. The fictional author's consciousness is the filter through which everything in the book passes. Yet Sterne sometimes invites the reader to question the opinions and assumptions that Tristram expresses, reminding us that Shandy is not a simple substitute for Sterne. One of the effects of this technique is to draw the reader into an unusually active and participatory role. Tristram counts on his audience to indulge his

idiosyncrasies and verify his opinions; Sterne asks the reader to approach the unfolding narrative with a more discriminating and critical judgment.